Usage of Present Conditional

The present conditional describes an action that would happen in certain circumstances. It translates to **"would"** in English.

Français	English
Le mois prochain, j'aimer**ais** voyager en Australie.	Next month, I would like to travel to Australia.
À votre place, j'étudier**ais** régulièrement.	If I were you, I would study regularly.
Tu ir**ais** là-bas, n'est-ce pas ?	You would go there, wouldn't you?

To Express a Desire/Wish

Français	English
Je **voudrais** finir ce projet aussitôt que possible.	I would like to finish this project as soon as possible.
Il **aimerait** rencontrer la femme de sa vie.	He would like to meet the woman of his life.
J'**aimerais** bien connaître votre fille.	I would really like to get to know your daughter.

Note: The desire can be reinforced by adding **"bien"** to the verb in the present conditional.

To Make Polite Requests

Français	English
Voudriez-vous dîner avec nous ce soir ?	Would you like to have dinner with us this evening?
Est-ce que tu **pourrais** me donner un coup de main ?	Could you give me a hand?
J'**aimerais** vous parler un instant.	I would like to talk to you for a moment.

Si + Imparfait, Present Conditional

Hypothesis with the Conditional

Français	English
Si **j'avais** de l'argent, je **partirais** en vacances.	If I had money, I would go on vacation.
Elle **s'amuserait** bien si son frère **était** là.	She would really have fun if her brother was here.
Si j'**étais** le fils de M. Ambani, je ne **ferais** pas la vaisselle.	If I were the son of Mr Ambani, I wouldn't do the dishes.

Au Cas Où + Present Conditional

Au cas où (in case) followed by **Present Conditional** to make a hypothesis.

Français	English
Je vais rester à côté de lui **au cas où il se réveillerait.**	I'll stay next to him in case he wakes up.
Au cas où vous rentreriez assez tôt, passez à la boulangerie acheter du pain.	In case you come back early enough, go by the bakery to buy bread.
Change tes habitudes **au cas où la police te surveillerait** toujours.	Change your habits just in case the police are watching you.

When the Conditional Is Used in English but Not in French

"Would do something" can translate to **"used to do something"** in English.
When describing habits from the past, French doesn't use conditional, it uses imparfait.

Français	English
En été, elle habitait à Paris, et en hiver, elle **emménageait** dans sa maison à Cannes.	In the summer, she would live in Paris, and in the winter, she would move to her house in Cannes.
Mon ami me volait de l'argent chaque fois que je lui **rendais visite.**	My friend would steal money from me every time I visited him.
Mon père et moi **allions pêcher** au lac tous les week-ends.	My dad and I would go fishing at the lake every weekend.

When the Conditional Is Used in French but Not in English

French Conditional: **Uncertain Information & Rumors**
In French, journalists and reporters often use the conditional to announce unconfirmed news.

Français	English
Après l'arrivée de l'ouragan, il semblerait que des centaines de maisons sans électricité.	After the arrival of the hurricane, it looks like hundreds of houses are without power.
Le président **voyagerait** en Afrique.	(It is rumored) The President is traveling to Africa.
La rumeur dit que Coldplay **sortirait** un autre album.	Rumour has it that Coldplay is going to release another album.

Using 'Faire Mieux' in the Present Conditional

Faire mieux + de + infinitive translates to "**would be better off**" **+ action**.

Français	English
Tu ferais mieux de te taire.	You would be better off being silent.
Ils feraient mieux de partir.	They would be better off leaving.